

1 MONADS

No self-respecting wannabe category theorist would leave out a description of monads. In this section, a comprehensive overview of monads will be given, with the Kleisli and Eilenberg-Moore categories defined in detail. Much of this comes directly from Mac Lane, and will begin with a quick remark on composeability of functors and natural transformations.

For a category $\mathbb{A}$, and endofunctor $T : \mathbb{A} \rightarrow \mathbb{A}$ there are composites $T^2 = T \circ T$ and $T^3 = T^2 \circ T$. If, additionally, there is a natural transformation $\mu : T^2 \rightarrow T$ then, for each a in $\mathbb{A}$, the natural transformations $T\mu, \mu T : T^3 \rightarrow T^2$ have, respectively components $(T\mu)_a = T\mu_a$, and $(\mu T)_a = \mu_{Ta}$.

Definition 1.1. [MacLCT] A *monad* $T = (T, \eta, \mu)$ in a category $\mathbb{A}$ consists of a functor $T : \mathbb{A} \rightarrow \mathbb{A}$ and two natural transformations

$$\eta : 1_{\mathbb{A}} \rightarrow T, \quad \mu : T^2 \rightarrow T$$

such that the following diagrams commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} T^3 & \xrightarrow{T\mu} & T^2 \\ \mu T \downarrow & & \downarrow \mu \\ T^2 & \xrightarrow{\mu} & T \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} 1T & \xrightarrow{\eta T} & T^2 & \xleftarrow{T\eta} & T1 \\ \blacksquare & & \mu \downarrow & & \blacksquare \\ T & \blacksquare & T & \blacksquare & T \end{array} \quad (1)$$